



CHRIST
UNIVERSITY
B E N G A L U R U , I N D I A

Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956

DEPARTMENT OF MEDIA STUDIES

JDM111-2 FUNDAMENTALS OF REPORTING

PORTFOLIO SUBMISSION

SUBMITTED BY- Saniya Ahmed

2 BAJE

2530158

**Under the guidance of Prof. Joel M Jacob
and Prof Tinam Borah**

Pet Lovers across Bengaluru unite in solidarity with streeties, defy Supreme Court order



Protesters in freedom park wear black while standing in solidarity

Pet lovers and social activist stood for hours in protest in Bengaluru's freedom park on 18th November at around 4:30 pm against the supreme court order to remove stray dogs from institutional areas like schools and hospitals and relocating to shelters after sterilization and vaccination.

The protesters pointed out that the order contradicts the Animal Birth Control (ABC) rules that clearly states dogs being returned to their original localities after sterilization.

The protest began sharp at 2:30 pm at freedom park near the Kuvempu statue and ended at around 5 pm in the evening. There was a strong police presence of around 50+ officers to avoid violence and heated debates. The protest remained peaceful and nonviolent throughout and corporate with the officials present. The protestors were dressed in black overalls to signify their disagreement with the supreme courts order.

Girish, a Bengaluru based business owner raised questions on the credibility of the supreme court judges to pass these orders and also asserted that they lack experience. He urged us to ask the right questions to the government. He pointed out the crucial data that is overlooked

by all about rabies death in the state of Karnataka itself. Death from rabies in Karnataka in this following year is 0 while the highlighted fact should be dog bites only in the urban cosmopolitan areas.

Another present protestor Minu Singh further talked about this key detail. Dog bites only occur in the urban parts of the city frequently. It is not because of rise in population in cities but that people have forgotten to coexist. In today's time all animals not only dogs are seen as an intrusion into the human dominated earth. She states that we have adopted the very western human centric ideology which places humans as the centre and dictator of the world. Stray animals seem out of place and dangerous to individuals because they have lost the touch with the cohabitants of our environment.



Amogh Varsha sharing his concerns

Advocate Anubhav Dubey stated that there is a potential legal and ethical issue in hand with the court's orders. He says that relocation of stray dogs must comply with established laws like the Animal Birth Control rules. Any order must be passed without haste and respecting the rights of communities.

Other government authorities refused to comment on the ongoing protest. Protestors voiced their concerns about these speechless creatures that are close to their heart. They warned of overcrowding in these shelters which leads to health concerns in dogs. Also pointing out another issue that removing dogs from their familiar territory could lead them to be aggressive in nature.

The protestors called upon the supreme court through this demonstration to reconsider their decision. They urged the government to treat and identify the dogs that need extra care and isolation. They emphasised the subject of not generalizing all dogs as dangerous due to few reported incidents. They urged the ABC awareness funds to be properly regulated and spent on awareness campaigns.

The protest was a significant act of statement with united people of all backgrounds and ages towards a singular goal of animal rights. The protest remained peaceful which showed that people just want to be heard and considered upon. It represented not an opposition but an

urge to make science backed policy for animals in India. They highlighted that even if the government goes forward with this policy, it would be great financial burden on the government to maintain thousands of dog shelters. The approximate cost calculated per dog according to ABC is rupees 3000. The street dogs await a terrible fate due to the one swipe of supreme court.

The event ended on happy note where everyone signed a petition and used their social media to spread the word on the same. The organizers requested all participants to sustain their activism until the court revisits this decision.

The miserable streets of JP Nagar from stinking stagnant water to potholes

The side of south Bengaluru which is plagued with the potholes and stagnant rainwater due to negligence of the concerned authorities. This issue continues to affects the lives of JP Nagar residents everyday despite urging authorities to take action. The residents have been trying to draw attention of the Bruhar Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike (BBMP) towards a permanent solution but very little efforts can be seen. Especially the condition aggravates every monsoon leaving the residents infuriated.

The JP Nagar civic problem gives a window towards other places of Bengaluru with the same struggles with the existing infrastructure. The residents complain of regular road digging for the purpose of changing pipelines but the roads are left unattended afterwards. This clearly shows the inefficiency and red tapism in the work of concerned administrators.



Condition of main road 6th phase JP Nagar, Krishna Devaraya Nagar

“The smell of the stagnant water is filthy that it makes me cover my nose when I walk by” said Mr Vinkesh who lives on the main street. I have called the BBMP helplines to take action but I receive mere excuses and delay. He also talks about how the infrastructure is only

taken care of when an election is around the corner and votes are needed. After years of blind side towards the issue it becomes important for the limited time of campaigning.

The parents of the locality are equally worried about the health of their children as the problems of sanitation gets worse. The children walk through the sewage mixed water puddles everyday fearing they might get sick. It is an issue larger than it looks. The clogged water brings mosquitos, bacteria and harmful waste to the main streets.

It has become an accident-prone area especially for the two wheelers passing by. A local shopkeeper also talked about the drastic decrease in his customers. The surroundings seem unpleasant and unhygienic to eat from his stall. Mr Shiva Kumar said “how people assume of his served food to be unhealthy due to the sight around him”.

Officer from BBMP office refuse to actually address this issue and comment on it. An officer did mention that the funds are not being used responsibly by the higher ranked offices. There is a viral social media outrage on the same issue and again the cycle of blame game continues with it.

There is a pattern being observed by the localities recalling ministers taking accountability in front of the media and talking about how the delay is due to the insufficient budget allotment which is evidently not the case. The residents have been consistent in filing their taxes and being a responsible citizen but the government is not so.

The residents have become immune to this existing issue as they know it's a cycle that continues. The frustration has been building up but again there is not a hint of change with these petitions or demonstrations. NGOs have talked about how this problem cannot be eradicated by just fixing the drainages and pipelines but a proper map needs to be integrated. An NGO called Namma Bengaluru Foundation has registered several cases of dengue and conducted their own survey submitting it to the BBMP but again there is lack of coordination.

This entire situation is disappointing for the reputation of a cosmopolitan city of India. It is a dichotomy to see there exist posh area in the same neighbourhood just because it has MNCs set up while the localities struggle with infrastructure. The Silicon Valley of India is struggling to maintain basic drainage system and proper roads is just shocking to see. There is just a waiting for a real accountability.



Post



DK Shivakumar 
@DKShivakumar



Deeply concerned by the havoc caused by relentless rains in Bengaluru. I've been in continuous touch with the concerned officers and I'm closely monitoring the situation.

As always, I remain committed to Bengaluru - working round the clock to address challenges and ensure relief.

I will be visiting the BBMP War Room and flood-affected areas personally to take stock on ground.

Let us be clear: the issues we face today are not new. They have been ignored for years, across governments and administrations. The only difference now is - we are working to solve them. Not with temporary fixes, but with long-term, sustainable solutions.

To my fellow Bengalureans - I am one among you. I understand your concerns, I share your frustration, and I assure you of my commitment to resolve them.

I stand with you.

[#BengaluruRains](#)

11:30 AM · May 19, 2025 · **651.5K** Views

Recent interaction of the Deputy Chief Minister of Karnataka

The Forgotten Backbones of this economy:

KR Market Fruit vendors



The busy streets of KR Market during dusk

In the early hours of the morning, when most of Bengaluru is asleep, the fruit vendors are already standing in KR Market with their hands buried in piles of different fruits. The air is thick with the smell of fresh fruit. The market wakes up in waves, the wholesalers shouting prices to the vendors quietly preparing for another uncertain day.

Viji(47F), a fruit vendor in the KR Market, says softly while stacking the fruits one by one, *“People think we just sit and sell fruits, but it is much tougher. Talking to people and taking their attitude is not easy.”*

But the real difficulty, she admits, is no longer the heat, the bargaining, or even the long hours. It is the sudden stillness. The quiet patches where people used to gather around her stall, chatting, comparing prices, and smelling the fruits. *“Now they don’t even stop,”* she says. *“Their eyes are in their phones.”*

Viji migrated to Karnataka from Tamil Nadu years ago, carrying with her a hope that her children would get the life she couldn't have. With no formal education of her own, she learned to survive through instinct and courage. Every rupee she earns from kiwi, mango, and pear sales is tied to her family's survival. *"We support our whole family with this,"* she continues. *"If business goes down more, I don't know what will happen."*

Across the street, in a narrow aisle, past crates stacked with pomegranates, sits **Rizwan Khan(35M)**. He is younger than Viji, but carries the same tiredness in his shoulders. The tiredness that comes from doing honest work in a world that has suddenly changed its rules.

Rizwan mainly sells pomegranates. Every morning, he travels to the wholesale market in Electronic City, returning with crates he arranges carefully. *"I'm trying my best to teach my kids,"* he says, half-smiling, though the worry in his eyes lingered. *"We didn't get an education, but we want to give it to our children. Why must they face what we did?"*

But giving education requires earning, and earning now feels like chasing an unstoppable target.

"Since Blinkit and Zepto came," he says. *"People don't pay attention to us. They say the delivery will come in ten minutes. How can we fight with our customers?"*

For **Lakshmi Rao(62F)**, buying fruits is not something she can imagine doing through a phone screen. Every morning, she stops at the same stretch of vendors and buys whatever is fresh that day. *"I come here daily. Not because I don't know about the apps, but because this is how I have always lived,"* he says.

Watching customers drift away to online platforms worries him. *"These people fed the city when there were no supermarkets, no delivery boys. But now people only crave convenience,"* he said tragically.



The picture where her eyes speaks louder than anything else

To an outsider, a fruit stall looks simple. But the work begins long before dawn, long before the first customer sees the bright, neatly stacked arrangement.

For decades, vendors like Viji and Rizwan were part of Bengaluru's morning rhythm. Their stalls were the original fresh-delivery systems. They fed the office-goers rushing to Majestic, school children returning home, and college friends exploring the streets.

Today, they feel themselves fading.

The rise of online grocery apps has changed more than how people buy fruit. It has changed who we see.

Where once the vendor's voice competed with traffic, now it competes with app notifications. Where once customers stopped to ask, "*How much today, akka?*", they now scroll up, tap, and wait for a delivery rider whose name they won't even remember tomorrow.

For Viji and Rizwan, this shift is more than economic. It is emotional. A slow erasure from the city they helped sustain.

Rizwan said it plainly, "*People want everything fast. They don't see us anymore. Only the phone.*"

Fruit vendors were never just sellers. They were storytellers, listeners, and everyday anchors. A regular customer could walk up to Viji, and she would already be picking out what they needed, not because of technology, but because of memory, relationship, and trust.

Now the apps claim to know your preferences. But they do not know your name. That intimacy, that slow, human connection, is disappearing. And with it, the livelihood of thousands.

The most intriguing part of KR Market is not the chaos. It is the sheer passion and determination of the people working there.

Despite shrinking income, Viji still arrives before dawn. Despite long hours, Rizwan still arranges his pomegranates with pride. They speak of struggle, but they do not speak of quitting. Quitting for them has never been an option.

Their work is not just about fruits. It is about identities and the struggles of these people who were the very backbone of the informal sector of economy.

It is a very simple truth that when vendors like Viji and Rizwan disappear, Bengaluru loses more than a cheap source of fruits. *It loses history. It loses community. It loses humanity.*

For now, they remain small islands of color and resilience in a city speeding past them.

But they hope the city pauses long enough to remember that *behind every fruit is a human story. Behind every stall is a family trying to live.*

And behind the convenience of a 10-minute delivery is someone who is slowly losing the only livelihood they have ever known.

Ink that Remembers all: The World of a Tattoo Artist

The hiss of the tattoo machine cuts through the pin drop silence of the room and sounds like the rhythm of someone's heartbeat which is being crafted over the years. Inside the small Mandalistic tattoo studio time slows down pain gets measures, memories become permanent and stories gets crafted on skin.

For Lalit, tattooing is much more than a mere artform- it's the art of listening.

As you enter the studio designs cover the walls: mandals, different scripts, geometry which is a scared symbol. He starts his day by wiping the chairs and arranging the needles with care. Clients will walk in through the door with a mix of nervousness and excitement carrying stories in their heavy hearts than the ink itself.

Lalit talks about how tattooing teaches patience and says "skin remembers everything"

He didn't grow up with the dream of becoming a tattoo artist it is life that navigated him here. Like all artist he grew up drawing quietly in his notebooks last pages and was often told his talent was just a distraction not a profession. Art is something that rich people can afford to have even as hobbies. For Lalit other responsibilities had to be met before thinning about his passion.

"I was told to choose science which was safe", he recalls while putting on his gloves. "Art was never seen as a career"

Leaving engineering behind in the last semester and realising that art is something that is a step closer to himself. When he finally started tatting real skin, he realised that this is much more than just drawing but a place of trust.

He talks about how people just don't come to get designs but come with a heart to engrave emotions such as grief, healing, rebellion and love. He has tattooed names, dates, symbols and other reminders which keeps so many individuals going.

"Tattoos become anchor to our feelings" he says. He tells a fresh story in his mind where a woman walks in asking to get a small lotus engraved on her wrist. As Lalit starts to draw, she talks about her difficult marriage and starting over in life. He believes that his job is more of an emotional labour. The place is more of confessional spot where strangers speak truths of their life which are too difficult to spoken anywhere else. Lalit never interrupts and only continues with his work.

Tattooing is painful that no new information but he believes behind the purpose of pain. "People think pain is bad" but pain means you are present and alive.

When a tattoo is finished the moment is scared for him as an artist. Clients look at their skin sometimes with a smile, sometimes crying. He lets them cherish each moment and emotion that comes with it.

In the society we live in tattoos are seen as vulgar or something indecent to have. Lalit often defends his profession when his relatives ask him to get a real job. But what matters for him is that other artist sees his studio as a space of acceptance.



Each tattoo connects him to the society in invisible ways. Tattoos are conversations more than a sketch. Conversations embedded in the souls of his clients. He doesn't measure his success as money but something even deeper which is loyalty, trust and pride that he shares with his customers.

In this space we have another individual who inks: Premjit. He is from Manipur and arrived in Bengaluru with addiction, guilt and lost in life. It was art which made him survive and live. He walked into the studio searching for direction which Lalit helped him with. His hunger to learn forced him to become sober and accountable.

Lalit and Premjit crafting a tattoo

Tattooing still carries so much of the prejudice and judgement. Families question the morality of these artists. Lalit and Premjit both face this every day. But inside the studio everything seems to dissolve. People return after years still carrying the ink that connects them to that scared memory.

Tattoos are conversation not rebellion as per Lalit. The job is not poetic as it seems some days are slow. Some evenings are spent without a client just sketching for oneself.

He emphasis on how people might forget their names but will never forget the imprint of ink on their skin which lies deeper into their blood. In the world filled with chaos and erasure, tattooing insists on permanence. It has a simple mantra this mattered, you mattered.



Lalit and his own symbolic tattoos

Tattoo is much like poetry exist for some reason which is not just mere decoration but an expression of survival. Because in the end what matters is that we are finite and mortals what leaves behind are memories and symbols.

Become one note at a time

He does not remember the exact time in his life where music became much more than a side quest hobby. For Sushmita Senguta, now a first-year postgraduate student of clinical psychology at IPER, music arrived in his life slowly and evolved into his passion with various phases of his life. The notes of music and the hold on strings of his first acoustic guitar grew onto him slowly and it became inseparable when music gave him the understanding of himself. In a typical Indian household where art is not seen as a noble pursuit in profession and more as just a hobby Sushmita found his entirety in music.

As a teenager in his 7th grade, he asked his parents for an electric guitar but the obvious answer of his parents was a no- not out of disregard but out of realism. But eventually his parents came around and gave him his first acoustic guitar. Clearly his parents were concerned that music does not provide stability and stability mattered. But by then Sushmit had learned that music was his space because he describes that he was average in all other things like academia and sports. It was music that made him feel special and a place where he was the best at.

The private relationship with music became communal soon and he joined a band. In Kolkata he found people who had the same urgency to create music. The band was built on late rehearsals and thrill of writing their own songs. There was an album in waiting for the band the future felt tangible but quietly the band fell apart. The album was left unreleased and silence and doubt followed his music now.

It was during this uncertain time stretch where his friends suggested that he tried content creation and shared his work. The suggestion was simple Sushmit didn't think much of it and started his journey but it somehow changed his journey. Social media was not his ambition and a creator on it was far away from his mind but it became a bridge between his isolation and audience. Posting music online meant learning an entirely new language like understanding the algorithms to reach mass audience. It demands regular content even when the inspiration was missing. This clashed with his sole purpose of creating music he could no longer make original music and share because that's not what the audience on Instagram like.

He created a balance between creating content for content sake and as he says "*upload and forget*". He still makes his original music and works on it simultaneously but keeps it private for now. At the core Sushmit is a musician who is more of a storyteller and he talks about how his keen observation of his surroundings have led to some of the best songs he has written. His songs do not just begin with words and lyrics but also random riffs, transition and arrangements finding shapes. He talks about his best creation a song called the *sinful womb*.

He tells me the real story behind the song itself he wrote that song on acceptance of a prostitute's son in the society. He further explains that music is political it cannot be just made for art's sake. Music should produce change and point out the voices of the unheard.

Formal music education and a degree in it never appealed to him. Sushmit chose psychology as his academic pursuit believing in the idea that art cannot be taught in an institution. Music for him personally is experimental and should come from experience and observation. He

also talks about how his study of psychology also contributes to the narratives of his song writing.



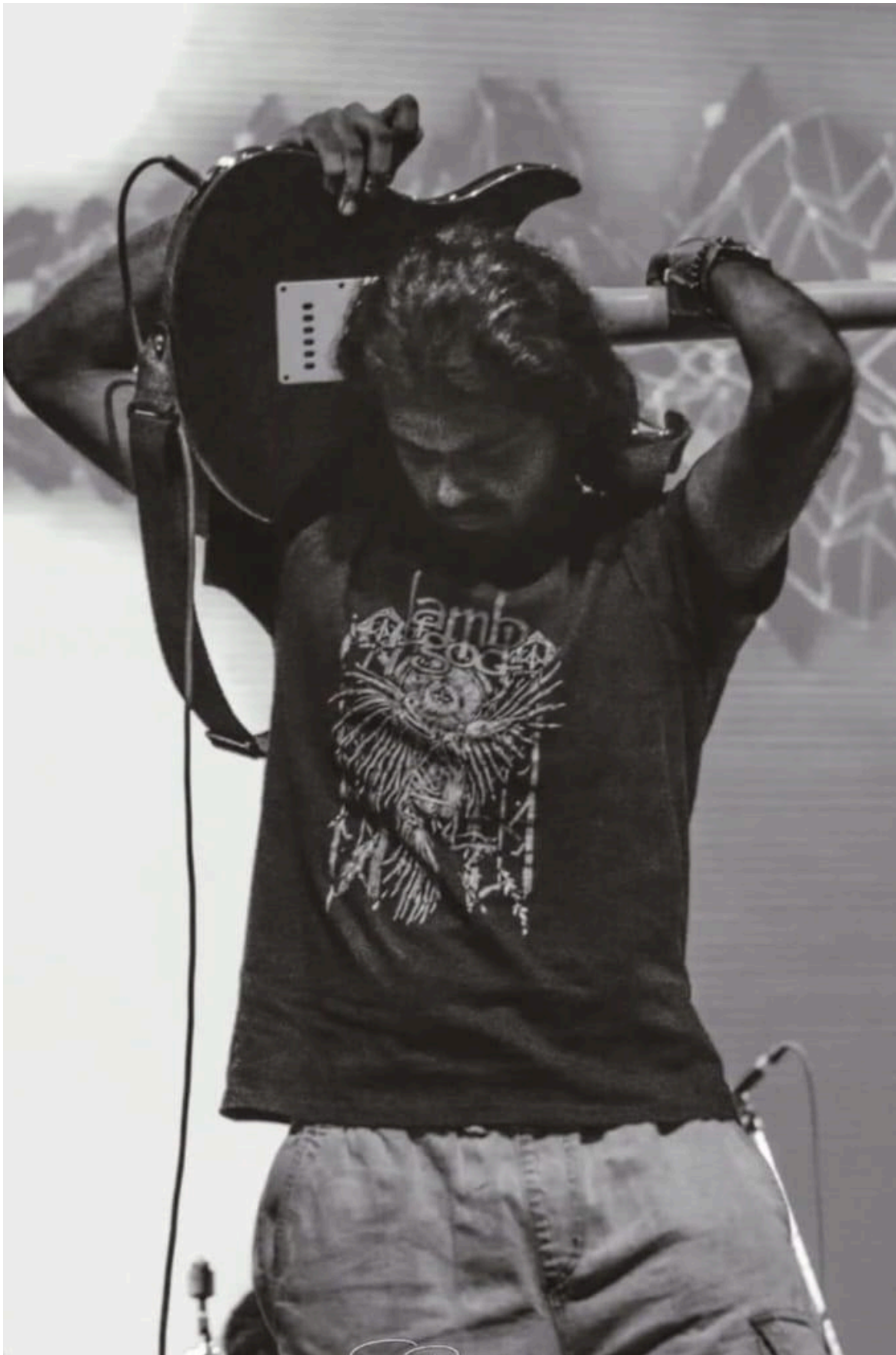
His place in Kolkata where he and his band once created music

One of the most defining moments in his career was when his band performed at the IIT Spring fest. It was not a mere stage performance but it was very he felt whole as a performer. What came to the surprise to the band was not the scale of the event but the people who showed up to the performance. A few of their fans and followers of the band's music travelled at the way from Kolkata and watched them perform. During the performance one of the listeners of their music sketched the entire interpretation of the sinful womb and gifted it to Sushmit. That moment changed how he understood having a reach in music. Even a small audience or a gathering could make a great impact.

Creative blocks often cloud his mind and he is unable to create music but what he does he steps away. He believes distancing and actually taking a break restores clarity rather than lingering onto the same thought. Patience is important he emphasis when it comes to creating any sort of art and one should make it their strength.

His close friend and ex band member Abhay Jeet says that Sushmits work feels lees like just normal music but a whole story woven into it. He also told us about Sushmit's first performance in stage and describes the awkward nervousness he had that day. There were thousands looking at him and all he could look at was his strings of guitar.

For Sushmit Sengupta success is not defined by the number of followers or views he has on reel but it is defined by the people listening, responding, understanding and most importantly connecting to his music. He giggles while telling us that if his life was a song, it would remain unfinished like one of his tunes and contently working on riffs. Perhaps that is what the essence of growth is to learn and create.



Sushmit in his performance in IIT FEST

